

How to Add Bootstrap Using CDN

A complete beginner-friendly guide: from searching for Bootstrap to writing your first working Bootstrap page

What You Will Learn

- How to find the official Bootstrap website.
- How to find the CDN links.
- Which Bootstrap CSS link to copy.
- Which JavaScript link to copy and when it is needed.
- Where to paste each link in an HTML file.
- How to create a complete working Bootstrap page.
- How to test that Bootstrap is working.

Before You Start

You need a web browser such as Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Opera and a code editor such as **Visual Studio Code** or Notepad. You do not need to install Bootstrap when using the CDN method.

STEP 1 - Open Your Browser

Open your preferred browser. For example, open **Google Chrome**.

You can use any browser. The steps are similar.

STEP 2 - Search for Bootstrap

In the browser's search bar, type:

```
Bootstrap official website
```

Press **Enter**.

STEP 3 - Open the Official Bootstrap Website

From the search results, open the official Bootstrap website. The official website is:

```
getbootstrap.com
```

Avoid copying CDN code from an unknown website. For lab work, it is better to use the official Bootstrap documentation/CDN information.

STEP 4 - Find the Bootstrap CDN Information

On the Bootstrap website, look for the documentation or the section that provides the CDN links. Bootstrap provides links for its CSS and JavaScript files.

For a simple lab project, you can use the Bootstrap 5.3.3 CDN links shown in this guide.

STEP 5 - Copy the Bootstrap CSS CDN

The CSS CDN is used for Bootstrap's **styling and layout**. Copy this line:

```
<link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
rel="stylesheet">
```

This link tells the browser to load Bootstrap's CSS file from the CDN.

STEP 6 - Create an HTML File

Open Visual Studio Code or another code editor.

Create a new file and save it as:

```
index.html
```

The .html extension tells the computer that this is an HTML document.

STEP 7 - Write the Basic HTML Structure

Start with the normal HTML structure:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8">
<title>My Bootstrap Page</title>
</head>
<body>

</body>
</html>
```

STEP 8 - Add the Viewport Meta Tag

Inside <head>, add the viewport meta tag. It helps the page behave correctly on mobile and tablet screens.

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
```

The viewport tag is especially important for responsive Bootstrap layouts.

STEP 9 - Add the Bootstrap CSS CDN

Paste the Bootstrap CSS CDN inside the <head> section.

```
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
<title>My Bootstrap Page</title>

<link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
rel="stylesheet">
</head>
```

Important: CSS links normally go inside <head>.

STEP 10 - Add Bootstrap HTML Components

Now you can use Bootstrap classes in your <body>. For example, create a Bootstrap button:

```
<button class="btn btn-primary">Click Me</button>
```

The classes btn and btn-primary come from Bootstrap.

STEP 11 - Decide Whether You Need Bootstrap JavaScript

Bootstrap JavaScript is **not required for every Bootstrap page**.

If you use...	Bootstrap JS needed?
Buttons, cards, grid, typography, spacing	No
Forms and basic styling	No
Carousel	Yes
Modal	Yes

If you use...	Bootstrap JS needed?
Dropdown	Yes
Accordion / Collapse	Yes
Offcanvas	Yes
Responsive navbar toggler	Yes

STEP 12 - Add Bootstrap JavaScript if Required

If your page uses a Bootstrap component that needs JavaScript, add this script near the end of the `<body>`:

```
<script
src="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/js/bootstrap.bundle.min.js"></script>
```

Yes, putting this script just before `</body>` is a common and recommended placement.

STEP 13 - Add Your Own CSS if Needed

If you have your own CSS file, put it after the Bootstrap CSS link when you want your styles to override Bootstrap styles.

```
<link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
rel="stylesheet">
<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
```

STEP 14 - Complete Working Code

Here is a complete beginner-level Bootstrap page using the CDN method:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="UTF-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
<title>Bootstrap Demo</title>

<!-- Bootstrap CSS -->
<link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/css/bootstrap.min.css"
rel="stylesheet">
</head>

<body>

<div class="container mt-5 text-center">
<h1 class="text-primary">Welcome to Bootstrap</h1>
<p class="lead">My first Bootstrap page.</p>
<button class="btn btn-primary">Click Me</button>
</div>

<!-- Bootstrap JavaScript -->
<script
src="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.3.3/dist/js/bootstrap.bundle.min.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

STEP 15 - Save the File

Save the file using **Ctrl + S**.

Make sure the file is saved as index.html and not index.html.txt.

STEP 16 - Open the HTML File in the Browser

Go to the folder where you saved index.html.

Double-click index.html, or right-click it and choose your browser.

If Bootstrap has loaded correctly, you should see a styled heading, paragraph, and blue Bootstrap button.

STEP 17 - Test Whether Bootstrap Is Working

Change the button to different Bootstrap classes and refresh the browser.

```
<button class="btn btn-success">Success</button>
<button class="btn btn-danger">Delete</button>
<button class="btn btn-warning">Warning</button>
```

If the buttons appear with Bootstrap styling, your Bootstrap CSS CDN is working.

Final Checklist

Check	What to verify
1	Browser opened and Bootstrap official website/CDN information found

Check	What to verify
2	index.html created
3	Viewport meta tag added
4	Bootstrap CSS CDN placed inside <head>
5	Bootstrap classes used in <body>
6	Bootstrap JS added only if interactive components need it
7	JS script placed near the end of <body>
8	File saved as .html
9	HTML opened in browser
10	Bootstrap styling tested

Easy rule to remember:

Bootstrap CSS CDN goes in <head>.

Bootstrap JavaScript, when needed, goes near the end of <body>.

Then use Bootstrap classes such as container, row, col, btn, text-center, and spacing classes.